PriceLabs Revenue Manager Guide - 2026-08-18

Executive Brief

PriceLabs is the pricing engine, not the strategy. The revenue manager job is to decide what the market should be trying to achieve, verify the data is telling the truth, and only then let PriceLabs do the mechanical work.

Use this guide when you need a practical weekly operating routine for a client account. The core questions are simple:

- Are we on pace for the goal?
- Is the issue price, demand, visibility, restrictions, listing quality, or data?
- Is the booking window open yet, or are we looking too early?
- Are we protecting the floor and the peak, or giving nights away below the market?

The most useful PriceLabs outputs are the ones that change decisions:

- base price, minimum price and maximum price;
- booking windows, pacing and pickup;
- market history, neighbourhood data and future prices;
- competitor calendar and comp availability;
- minimum-stay rules and their fit to the live booking window;
- occupancy, ADR, revenue and rate-position signals;
- listing health, ranking and OTA conversion clues.

Damiano should use PriceLabs as a monitored pricing layer inside a wider revenue system. The wider system includes PMS truth, listing quality, market context, owner goals, seasonality, and human judgement. Software can recommend. Strategy is still the human job.

Client Revenue Review Checklist

Use this checklist for every client review, whether it is a new onboarding, a weekly check, or a monthly deep dive.

1. Confirm the goal per listing.

- What is the target: revenue, occupancy, ADR, or a blend?
- Is the target realistic for the market and product type?
- Has the owner given a hard floor or a preferred trade-off?

2. Check the cost floor before anything else.

- Do not review prices without knowing break-even.
- Include rent or ownership cost, cleaning, utilities, platform fees, management cost and taxes where relevant.
- If the minimum price is below the real floor, the strategy is already broken.

3. Review base price.

- Ask whether the base price was set from performance data or guessed at setup.
- Base price should reflect the listing's true positioning, not wishful thinking.
- If the base is stale, every downstream signal becomes noisy.

4. Review minimum price.

- Minimum price is the protection line, not a suggestion.
- It should usually sit above break-even with buffer.
- If it is too low, the system will trade profit for false occupancy.

5. Review maximum price.

- Maximum price prevents the model from going silly on event dates.
- Too low and you cap upside.
- Too high and you lose credibility in the far-out calendar.

6. Check market history.

- Look at past occupancy, ADR and revenue patterns by month and season.
- Compare against the same period last year where data exists.
- History should explain what the market actually does, not what it theoretically should do.

7. Check neighbourhood data.

- Use it to understand market occupancy, pace, seasonality and percentile position.
- Look at whether the market is rising, flat or soft.
- Treat neighbourhood data as a benchmark, not the final answer.

8. Check future prices.

- Look at the next 30, 60 and 90 days.
- Ask whether the calendar is priced to capture demand at the right time.
- Watch for date clusters that are too cheap, too rigid, or too far above market.

9. Check competitor calendar.

- A fair price is not enough if the comp set is available and you are not.
- Review competitor occupancy, availability and booking momentum.
- Availability context often explains more than headline rates.

10. Check minimum-stay rules.

- Minimum stay must fit the booking window.
- A 2-night minimum can kill live demand in a 0-1 day booking market.

- Min-stay should help the booking wave, not block it.

11. Check occupancy and pace.

- Separate booked nights from available nights.
- Ask whether the listing is catching the market wave or missing it.
- Low occupancy can be a price problem, a restriction problem, or a visibility problem.

12. Check listing content and OTA ranking.

- Good pricing cannot fix a weak title, photos, description, reviews or map pin.
- If ranking is weak, pricing is only one part of the problem.
- Conversion quality matters more when the market is competitive.

13. Check for expensive mistakes.

- Stacked discounts.
- Stale overrides.
- Unexplained min-stay tightening.
- Price cuts made from emotion.
- Repricing without checking PMS truth.

Booking Window And Pacing Playbook

The booking window tells you when the market is actually shopping for a date. The pace tells you whether your listing is keeping up.

What To Watch

- Booking window: how many days before check-in demand normally appears.
- 7-day pickup: how much market occupancy has moved in the last week.
- 30-day occupancy: whether the calendar is filling in line with the market.
- Pace versus target: are we ahead, on track, or behind?
- Pace versus last year: is this date behaving like a normal seasonal pattern?

How To Read It

- If the market booking window has not opened yet, do not panic about a quiet future month.
- If the window is open and the market is moving while you are flat, investigate restrictions or pricing position.
- If the market is filling and the listing is not, the problem is usually min-stay or price position before it is anything else.
- If the listing is ahead of market pace, do not automatically discount. Protect rate first.

Practical Pace Signals

- Ahead of market: hold or raise, and consider tightening minimum stay if the calendar is moving early.
- Slightly behind market: diagnose before discounting.
- Clearly behind market: check booking window fit, then min-stay, then discount stacking, then price percentile.
- No bookings at all: confirm the month is actually in season and inside its booking window before treating it as failure.

Monday Pace Check

Do this every Monday for each portfolio cluster:

- check market occupancy next 30 days versus last week;
- check listing occupancy next 30 days versus last week;
- check whether the price percentile is rising, flat, or falling;
- write one line per listing: catching the wave, missing the wave, or no wave yet.

Practical Operating Playbook

1. Start with the commercial goal

Before opening PriceLabs, decide what success means.

- Revenue-first: protect ADR and avoid cheap occupancy.
- Occupancy-first: fill nights, but do not undercut the floor.
- Balanced: hold rate where the market supports it and use tactics only where they matter.

If the goal is unclear, the prices will be too.

2. Verify the data truth

Check the PMS and PriceLabs together.

- Are synced reservations current?
- Are blocked dates genuine or stale?
- Do booked nights match what the channel says?
- Is the listing actually connected and updating?

Never make a judgement from PriceLabs alone when PMS truth is available.

3. Read the market before changing prices

Use market history and neighbourhood data first.

- Is the market up, flat, or soft?
- Is the date inside its live booking window?
- Is the market booking late or early?
- Are comp nights disappearing because demand is real, or because the set is being reduced?

4. Check the listing against the market

If demand is weak, ask whether the problem is actually conversion.

- title and first photo;
- description and amenity completeness;
- review strength;
- map pin and location clarity;
- cancellation policy;
- OTA ranking and visibility.

A good price on a weak listing still loses.

5. Check restrictions before discounting

Most missed bookings are not solved by lower prices.

- minimum stay too long for the current booking window;
- check-in or check-out rules that block demand;
- blocked dates left behind by mistake;
- stacked discount logic;
- channel markup or parity issues.

6. Use PriceLabs as a control layer

In PriceLabs, the working order should usually be:

- confirm base price;
- confirm minimum price;
- confirm maximum price;
- check neighbourhood data and market position;
- check future prices by date range;
- inspect competitor calendar and availability;
- confirm min-stay rules match the booking window;
- then decide whether a change is needed.

7. Keep the one-lever rule

Only one discount mechanism should act on a date.

- seasonal profile or date override or last-minute discount;
- not two;
- not three.

Stacked discounts are an expensive way to train the market to expect bargain pricing.

8. Separate monitoring from action

PriceLabs can show the problem.

Damiano decides whether the response is:

- no action;
- a rule adjustment;
- a price adjustment;
- a listing/content fix;
- a channel fix;
- an owner conversation.

Low-Booking Diagnosis

When bookings slow down, diagnose in this order.

1. Goal fit

- Is the goal realistic for the market and the product?

2. Data fit

- Are PMS and PriceLabs synced?
- Are there stale blocks, old overrides or missing reservations?

3. Booking window fit

- Is the month actually in its active booking window?
- If not, stop overreacting.

4. Min-stay fit

- Is the minimum stay too long for live demand?
- Are you filtering out short-booking demand that the market is actually taking?

5. Price position

- Is the listing above the comp set for no good reason?
- Is it below the market and still not converting, which suggests a different issue?

6. Visibility and ranking

- Is the listing easy to find?
- Is the OTA or direct site doing its job?

7. Content quality

- Does the listing look premium enough to convert?

8. Channel and owner constraints

- Are markups, rules or owner restrictions killing the offer?

Only after that should pricing change.

Where Pricing Software Ends And Strategy Begins

PriceLabs can calculate, recommend and automate. It cannot decide what outcome the owner actually wants.

Pricing software ends at:

- generating market-based rates;
- showing booking window and pace signals;
- applying the rule set;
- flagging market context.

Strategy begins at:

- setting the goal;
- deciding the trade-off between occupancy and ADR;
- knowing when not to discount;
- deciding whether the issue is price or something else;
- explaining the decision to the owner;
- tracking whether the decision worked.

If the market is soft, the wrong answer is not always lower prices. Sometimes the answer is better content, looser stay rules, stronger visibility, or patience until the booking window opens.

AI Workflows

Use AI where it speeds up analysis without replacing judgement.

- Draft the weekly review summary from PriceLabs and PMS signals.
- Summarise market changes and booking-window movement.
- Draft owner explanations in plain English.

- Build a recommendation log so past decisions are not forgotten.
- Turn dashboards into a short action list instead of a pile of numbers.
- Use closed knowledge sources for SOP answers and property-specific instructions.

Do not use AI to hide uncertainty.

- If the data is missing, say so.
- If the booking window has not opened, say so.
- If the answer depends on owner strategy, say so.
- If a price change would be client-facing or externally committed, keep it approval-gated.

Expensive Revenue-Management Mistakes

These are the mistakes that cost the most money.

- Setting the base price from instinct instead of performance.
- Letting the minimum price drift below the real floor.
- Using too many discount layers on the same dates.
- Over-tightening minimum stay and blocking the live booking window.
- Reacting to one empty day instead of the wider pace picture.
- Ignoring market history and comparing the listing to the wrong season.
- Changing price without checking PMS truth.
- Treating a ranking problem as a pricing problem.
- Letting stale overrides live in the calendar.
- Pushing occupancy by discounting through the peak.
- Forgetting that a cheap calendar can still be a bad calendar.

Repeatable Weekly Workflow For Client Accounts

Monday

- Review the booking window, 7-day pickup and market occupancy movement.
- Check each managed listing against target pace.
- Flag underperformers and state the likely cause category.

Wednesday

- Review competitor calendar, market history and future prices.
- Check whether the content or visibility layer is constraining bookings.

- Decide whether any one-lever change is worth proposing.

Friday

- Review next-week risk and any orphan nights.
- Check min-stay settings against the live calendar.
- Prepare the owner or internal summary for the week.

Monthly

- Review closed-month occupancy, ADR, revenue and pace versus target.
- Check whether the cost floor still makes sense.
- Review listing quality, ranking and seasonal strategy.
- Record what was changed and what happened after the change.

Source Notes

English sources used:

- `xn2-HztVYPA` - `RM Mastery Lab - Series 2 - API Updates, MCP, and Macroeconomic Trends`
- `D7Tp2BCRvJs` - `4 AI Workflows Every Property Manager Should Start Using Today`

Local strategy and SOP sources used:

- `ORL_PRICELABS_CUSTOMER_API_EXTRACTION_2026-07-08.md`
- `ORL_Full_RM_SOP_v2.0_2026-08-15_EXTRACTED_TEXT.md`
- `ORL_HYBRID_REVENUE_MANAGER_POSITIONING_2026-07-29.md`
- `ORL_PRICELABS_MASTERY_AND_SAJIDA_GOALS_PLAN_2026-07-29.md`
- `ORL_REVENUE_MANAGER_AI_WEBSITE_WORKFLOW_2026-08-15.md`

Notes:

- Repeated language versions were not used.
- This guide is operational and operator-focused, not a transcript dump.
- It is designed for weekly client-account execution, not generic training.